A Place for Static Web Pages

The `public` directory is the external face of your application. The web server takes this directory as the base of the application. In here you place *static* (in other words, unchanging) files, generally related to the running of the server.

A Place for Script Wrappers

If you find it helpful to write scripts that are launched from the command line and perform various maintenance tasks for your application, the `bin` directory is the place to put wrappers that call those scripts.

This directory also holds the Rails script. This is the script that's run when you run the `rails` command from the command line. The first argument you pass to that script determines the function Rails will perform:

console
: Allows you to interact with your Rails application methods.

dbconsole
: Allows you to directly interact with your database via the command line.

destroy
: Removes autogenerated files created by `generate`.

generate
: A code generator. Out of the box, it will create controllers, mailers, models, scaffolds, and web services. Run `generate` with no arguments for usage information on a particular generator; here's an example:

```
bin/rails generate migration
```

new
: Generates Rails application code.

runner
: Executes a method in your application outside the context of the Web. This is the noninteractive equivalent of `rails console`. You could use this to invoke cache expiry methods from a `cron` job or handle incoming email.